

Student Life

MScAC Orientation Week

David — MScAC (Applied Math) 2025-2026

Before we start... where in the GTA are you?

- Scan the QR code or open the link to join the live map
- Duplicate a pin, drag it onto your neighbourhood



Live GTA map

WEEKENDS IN TORONTO

Weekends in Toronto: Summer/Fall

- Parks & waterfront: High Park (cherry blossoms in spring), Toronto Islands (ferry ~\$10 return), Waterfront Boardwalk
- Neighbourhoods: Chinatown, Koreatown (Bloor & Christie), Greektown (the Danforth), Little Italy (College St)
- Niagara Falls (day trip, GO train or bus or car) + Niagara-On-The-Lake
- Blue Jays game at Rogers Centre
- Canadian National Exhibition (late August)

Weekends in Toronto: Spring

- Ice Skating at U of T Varsity Arena (\$3.30 rental)
- Earl Bales Ski & Snowboard Center (North York)
- Blue Mountain Ski Resort
- Culture: Royal Ontario Museum (student rate, also free on Tuesdays)
- Cards to get: PRESTO, Toronto Public Libraries

MSCAC STUDENT INITIATIVE FUND

A few things the cohort has run this year

Event	What it was	Funded
Ski Trip (Blue Mountain)	Full-day ski/snowboard trip, bus + lift tickets subsidized	\$2,760
Bouldering & Social Mixer	Climbing + dinner, peer mentorship for beginners	\$1,050
Board Game Nights	4-week recurring series	\$650
CNY Celebration & Alumni Mixer	Dinner, Lo Hei, karaoke, alumni invited back	\$2,315
ML Trivia Night	Dinner + trivia ahead of recruiting season	\$960

Look at all the fun we've had



Other ideas to start you off this Fall

Idea	Description	Cost
K1 Speed Go-Karting (North York)	Great fun near the Downsview Park TTC	\$82/person
Basecamp Climbing (Queen West)	Self-explanatory and we had dinner subsidised too	\$35/person
Canada's Wonderland	The GTA's rollercoaster park	\$45/person
Activate Toronto (Stockyards)	All-ages arcade park; 75-min active session	\$30/person

Running an event

- In the office
 - Location: MScAC Office rooms like 9016
 - Food: order delivery where possible — Mother's Dumpling (Chinese), Tahini's (shawarma), pizza (you'll get sick of this)
 - Stock up on cutlery, plates and cups from Dollarama
 - Buy big bottles of drinks from Shoppers
- Outside the office
 - Show up, snap a picture or two, have fun

Guidelines from MScAC

- Open to the entire cohort
- No alcohol, gambling / games of chance (stakes, betting pools, wagering)
- Proposal is one page: summary, goals, benefits, timeline, itemized budget (just use my Claude Code repo or something)
- You must be registered + in good academic standing (which is why us alumni need you to keep this up)

Typical timeline

- Submit a proposal 2 weeks ahead (the start of the semester is always a little busier)
- MScAC promises to confirm funding within 5 business days of your email
- After event: submit the attendance list (Partiful / written attendance sheet / Google Form), receipts, copy of original invite, and photos if applicable
- Expect reimbursement via cheque/direct deposit (if you're a TA) about 4-6 weeks after
- Past asks have ranged \$650 – \$2,760 depending on format and scale

Student Initiatives Process

- 1. Discord poll — gauge interest before writing anything
- 2. Submit one-page proposal — real example at end of presentation
- 3. Partiful — collect RSVPs + dietary restrictions once confirmed
- 4. EVENT
- 5. Submit receipts + attendee list + invitation
- 6. Reimbursement lands in ~4-6 weeks

(switching to the actual Bouldering proposal document)

WHAT A REAL PROPOSAL ACTUALLY LOOKS LIKE

WANT TO RUN ONE YOURSELF?

Pick one, co-run it with me:

- K1 Speed Go-Karting (round 2)
 - Basecamp Climbing
 - Canada's Wonderland
 - Activate Toronto
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- I'll help with the proposal, the budget, and the logistics to get you started.
 - Sign up here: [Discord link — TBD]

Thanks!

[QR code to Discord signup — add once link is set]